The Deal Check — Sample First-Pass Checklist

WHAT THIS IS: At Google there was a whole checklist of what Google wants — then we went from there. This is that first pass, rebuilt as mine: the check I run on any client deal before it moves. It is a SAMPLE, built from my own working method (Doc 02, Section 2a, Question 1). For a client's company, their own house checklist plugs into Step 6 — and if they don't have one, that is the first finding.

Step 1 — The Why

☐ What are we doing?

☐ Why? (The why drives the action.)

Step 2 — The Client's Status

☐ What does the client have right now?

☐ What's the client's current deal?

☐ Is this a renewal or is this brand new?

☐ Are they eligible?

Step 3 — The Signal

☐ What do the stakeholders want? (Name each stakeholder. Write the want next to the name.)

Step 4 — Did They Do Their Part

☐ Docs: all here?

☐ Info: complete?

☐ What's missing? (Missing docs, missing info — that is the tell. Simple stuff, really.)

☐ Is the approval there? (Sometimes the missing piece is the approval.)

☐ Reverse check: anything approved that was not supposed to be?

Step 5 — What Is Blocking It

☐ Is the blocker the missing pieces?

☐ Or is a policy in the way?

☐ If it's policy: can we bend it — or break it and then recreate it — so we can make more money?

Step 6 — The House Checklist

☐ Run the client's own required checklist, in full.

☐ No house checklist exists? Record that as a finding, not a footnote.

The principle under all six steps: “The big work is reading the process.”

STATUS: Sample v1, built 2026-10-25 from Lucky's locked Q1 answer; client wording pass the same night at his instruction. Client-specific items get filled in per engagement. Nothing on this checklist came from a template library — every step is a step he actually runs.

TRACK BACK: Front door: 00 — The Map. Source: 02 — Positioning (Draft v1), Section 2a, Q1. Master index: Drive Table of Contents. Logged in tab -19, Log 4.